

Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan

1. Introduction

The purpose of this Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan is to ensure the continuation of business during and following any critical incident that results in disruption to normal operational capability.

1.1 Developing a Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan

This Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan incorporates the Prevention, Preparedness, Response and Recovery (PPRR) framework. Each of the four key elements is represented by a part in the Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Planning Process.

Business Continuity Planning Process



(a) Prevention - Risk Management planning

Incorporates the Prevention element that identifies and manages the likelihood and/or effects of risk associated with an incident.

(b) Preparedness - Business Impact Analysis

Incorporates the Preparedness element that identifies and prioritises the key activities of a business that may be adversely affected by any disruptions.

(c) Response – Incident Response planning

Incorporates the Response element and outlines immediate actions taken to respond to an incident in terms of containment, control and minimising impacts.

(d) Recovery - Recovery planning

Incorporates the Recovery element that outlines actions taken to recover from an incident in order to minimise disruption and recovery times.

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1.2 Distribution List and person responsible for implementation of Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan

{org.primary_contact.name} and {org.signatory.name}
Principal
{org.email}
{org.phone}

1.3 References and related documents

Risk Management Policy
Risk Register
Work Health and Safety Policy
COVID-19 Pandemic Management Policy
Human Resources Management Policy
Cloud Based Storage System

1.4 Location of Emergency Kit

Residence of {org.primary_contact.name} and {org.signatory.name} and electronic copy stored on Cloud Based Storage System.

2. Objectives

The objectives of this Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan are to:

- undertake risk management assessment
- define and prioritise critical business functions
- detail immediate response to a critical incident
- detail strategies and actions to be taken to enable business continuation
- review and update the plan on a regular basis.

3. Definitions

In this Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan:

{org.name} means {org.legal_name} ABN {org.abn}

Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Planning means a process that helps develop a plan document to manage the risks to a business, ensuring that it can operate to the extent required in the event of a crisis/disaster.

Client means a client of {org.name} (including an NDIS participant).

Legislation Register means the register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by {org.name}.

Policy Register means the register of policies of {org.name}.

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Principal means {org.primary_contact.name} and {org.signatory.name}.

reasonably practicable is that which is, or was at a particular time, reasonably able to be done in relation to ensuring workplace health and safety, taking into account and weighing up all relevant matters including:

- (a) the likelihood of the hazard or the risk concerned occurring; and
- (b) the degree of harm that might result from the hazard or the risk; and
- (c) what the person concerned knows, or ought reasonably to know, about:
 - (1) the hazard or the risk; and
 - (2) ways of eliminating or minimising the risk; and
- (d) the availability and suitability of ways to eliminate or minimise the risk; and
- (e) After assessment, the extent of the risk and the available ways of eliminating or minimising the risk, the cost associated with available ways of eliminating or minimising the risk, including whether the cost is grossly disproportionate to the risk.

Risk Management is a process whereby hazards are identified, the risks associated with the identified hazard are assessed and the control measures which will eliminate or minimise the risk of injury from the identified hazard are planned and implemented.

Worker means a permanent, fixed term or casual member of staff, a contractor or volunteer employed or otherwise engaged by {org.name} and includes the Principal.

4. Risk Management Planning

4.1 Service Listing

NDIS services are provided and quoted in accordance with the NDIS Price Guide.

Other services provided by {org.name} are quoted based on the nature and scope of services provided to the Client.

4.2 Risk Register

Refer to the {org.name} Risk Register which identifies the risks and hazards that may have an adverse effect on the business and chooses the best method of dealing with each of those identified risks as well as other potential controls.

4.3 Insurances

Certificates of currency included with the Emergency Kit.

4.4 Data security and backup strategy

Refer to the Risk Register.

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5. Critical Business Risk Analysis

Rank	Critical business areas	Impact if failed	Current protection strategies
	Key person risk	The Principal and Key Management Personnel are critical to the business's success and delivery of services and supports. Revenue and service delivery may suffer if the Principal is unavailable to provide services due to unplanned absence.	The board to determine the person(s) to take responsibility for the operation of the business in accordance with Delegation of Authority
	Fire, flood, theft, pandemic (for example, COVID-19) or other business interruption)	Inability to provide supports and services to Clients	Relevant insurances maintained. Alternative workplaces/accommodation will be sourced and used while damage is being repaired including arrangements to be made with alternative providers in the area to take Clients into their care. Evacuation Procedures and Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Policy in the event of an emergency.
	Worker impairment or absence	Ability to provide continuity of supports	In the event of any unavoidable changes to support provision, for example, due to worker impairment or absence (due to planned and unplanned leave), the following care continuity plan will apply: - Step 1 - attempt to find a suitably qualified and/or experienced Worker at {org.name} to fill in on a temporary basis to provide support to the Client while their regular Worker is absent. - Step 2 (should Step 1 be or become unworkable or extend for more than a few weeks) - engage an external agency (such as Drake or Mabel) or

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			source from the professional network of {org.primary_contact.name} and {org.signatory.name} to provide short term worker assistance or otherwise recruit for the role. - Ensure that inductions of these workers occur in accordance with the Staff Induction Checklist and otherwise ensure they have the appropriate competencies to deliver the appropriate services and supports in accordance with the expectations of the NDIS Practice Standards. - Step 3 (should the impairment or unplanned absence become permanent) - Recruit a new worker to act in the role. Where changes or interruptions are unavoidable, all alternative arrangements are explained and agreed with the Client.
	Data breach	Loss of client records and breaches of confidentiality and privacy	Electronic client records are kept in the business's secure cloud based storage system. Hard-copy organisational, operational, financial and business documents kept in the filing cabinet kept at the Principal's residence. Copy of key documents kept with accountants. Electronic operational, financial and business documents kept in cloud based storage systems.
	COVID-19	Infection of Workers and Clients. Inability to provide supports and services to Clients	Please see Risk Register, COVID-19 Pandemic Management Policy and Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Policy

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6. Evacuation

6.1 Evacuation Procedures

(a) Ambulance

- (1) USE NEAREST PHONE TO SITE OF EMERGENCY CALL 000 AND ASK FOR AMBULANCE
- (2) STATE ADDRESS
- (3) CALL BACK NUMBER – {org.phone} or an alternate phone
- (4) Number of Patients
- (5) Symptoms eg Chest Pain
- (6) ADVISE – State of consciousness
- (7) Patient's Name and Date of Birth
- (8) BE PREPARED TO MEET THE AMBULANCE

(b) Bomb Threat

- (1) REMAIN CALM
- (2) Keep the caller talking and try to gain as much information as possible
- (3) DO NOT HANG UP YOUR PHONE
- (4) If possible, alert another staff member
- (5) Using an alternate phone, call 000 and ask for Police
- (6) STATE ADDRESS
- (7) CONTACT NUMBER – {org.phone}

(c) Fire

- (1) ALERT ALL BUILDING OCCUPANTS TO PREPARE FOR EVACUATION
- (2) CALL 000 ask for Fire
- (3) STATE ADDRESS
- (4) CONTACT NUMBER – {org.phone}
- (5) Account for all Personnel
- (6) If safe to do so, attempt to extinguish fire with available equipment (Ensure you have the correct extinguisher for the type of fire)
- (7) EVACUATE – Ensure all doors behind you are CLOSED

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- (8) DO NOT go back inside – AWAIT FIRE BRIGADE

(d) **Armed Robbery**

- (1) Obey the robbers' instructions; Do only what they say and nothing more. DO NOT BE A HERO
- (2) Stay out of danger; Raise alarm only when safe to do so
- (3) CALL 000 AND ASK FOR POLICE
- (4) STATE ADDRESS
- (5) CONTACT NUMBER – {org.phone}
- (6) If possible, another staff member should try and note the robbers escape vehicle and route
- (7) Close the office and ask any witnesses to remain until Police arrive
- (8) Whilst awaiting the Police, DO NOT touch anything the robber may have handled
- (9) Make clear notes about their appearance, age, accent, mannerism, height, jewelry, clothing etc

6.2 Emergency kit

Items included in Emergency Kit:

- (a) Business Continuity, Emergency and Disaster Preparedness Plan – your plan to recover your business or organisation in the event of a critical incident.
- (b) Policies and Procedures
- (c) Insurance company details.
- (d) Key financial information.
- (e) Patient records which are in hard copy

7. Immediate Response Checklist

Incident Response	☐	Actions taken
Have you:		
● assessed the severity of the incident?	☐	
● evacuated the site if necessary?	☐	

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• accounted for everyone?	☐	
• identified any injuries to persons?	☐	
• contacted Emergency Services?	☐	
• implemented your Incident Response Plan?	☐	
• started an Event Log?	☐	
• gained more information as a priority?	☐	
• briefed Workers on the incident?	☐	
• allocated specific roles and responsibilities?	☐	
• identified any damage?	☐	
• identified critical activities that have been disrupted?	☐	
• kept staff and Clients informed?	☐	
• contacted key stakeholders?	☐	
• understood and complied with any regulatory/compliance requirements?	☐	
• Notified NDIS Commission?	☐	

8. Recovery

8.1 Recovery Checklist

Decisions	☐	Actions
Now that the crisis is over have you:	☐	
• refocused efforts towards recovery?	☐	
• deactivated Workers and resources as necessary?	☐	
• continued to gather information about the situation as it affects you?	☐	
• assessed your current financial position?	☐	
• reviewed cash requirements to restore operations?	☐	
• contacted your insurance broker/company?	☐	
• developed financial goals and timeframes for recovery?	☐	

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